CITY OF CORONADO
MEASURE D

(This measure will appear on the ballot in the following form.)

MEASURE D

Shall the measure, increasing the permissible height of "multiple-family developments" in the City of Coronado's R-4 Multiple Family Residential Zone from the existing maximum of 3 stories (with a maximum height of no more than 35 feet) to a maximum of 4 stories (with a maximum height of no more than 42 feet), be adopted?

This measure requires Simple Majority (50%+1) of those voting on the measure.

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS

The City Council of the City of Coronado placed Measure D on the ballot for voter consideration at the November 3, 2026, election.

Coronado Municipal Code ("CMC") Section 86.56.048 and Section B-2 of Part B of Chapter V of the Orange Avenue Corridor Specific Plan ("OACSP") currently limit the height of multiple-family developments in the R-4 Multiple-Family Residential Zone ("R-4 Zone") to a maximum building height of three stories with a maximum 35-foot height limit ("Existing Height Limit").

As part of the City's Sixth Cycle Housing Element Update adoption ("Housing Element Update"), the California Department of Housing and Community Development ("HCD") took the position that the Existing Height Limit constitutes a constraint on developments seeking to obtain the permitted density of 40 dwelling units per acre. Further, per HCD's guidance, a zoning district must allow at least one story and 10 feet of height for every 10 dwelling units per acre of density allowed. In other words, the R-4 Zone's density of 40 dwelling units per acre must correspond with a height limit no lower than 4 stories and 40 feet and HCD has expressed that 42 feet is preferred to avoid constraining the density. As a result, the Housing Element Update contains Program H.1.F that requires the City to submit Measure D to the voters.

If approved, Measure D would revise the height limits in both the CMC 86.56.048 and the OACSP pertaining to multiple family developments in the R-4 Zone so that the maximum building height is four stories but no more than 42 feet. This revision will be in compliance with HCD's requirements stated above.

A "Yes" vote is a vote in favor of Measure D, which is a vote in favor of revising the height limits as stated above. "No" vote is a vote against Measure D, which is a vote against revising the height limits as stated above. Measure D will be approved if it receives a simple majority of "Yes" votes.

Johanna N. Canlas
City Attorney, City of Coronado

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure D. If you desire a copy of the ordinance or measure, please call the election official's office at 619-522-7320 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE D

For over fifty-four years, Coronado voters sought to protect the village character of our City. Measure D asks residents to give that protection away.

The R-4 Multiple-Family Residential Zone governs the core of Orange Avenue between Second and Eighth Streets. Since 1972, Proposition R has capped affected building heights in that zone at three stories. Measure D would raise the limit to four stories and 42 feet.

The mandate driving this measure rests on rigged math. Every eight years, California requires cities to adopt a Housing Element to accommodate housing allocations set by SANDAG. For the 2021–2029 cycle, Coronado was mandated to zone for 912 new units, requiring higher density rezoning. To calculate their mandate, SANDAG counted 10,000+ jobs on Coronado's Navy bases, though a majority of service-members don't reside here. Inexplicably, they also excluded existing Navy housing to account for service-members who do live on base.

City Council fought hard against the SANDAG housing density mandate. However, in 2023 the City signed a settlement agreement under threat of $100,000 monthly fines and loss of local zoning authority. In March 2024, our City's Planning Commission voted unanimously to reject the Housing Element. It was a symbolic, principled vote. City Council then reluctantly adopted the Housing Element to maintain some local zoning control and to ensure that Navy housing for sailors can offset density calculations in the current and future SANDAG mandates.

Coronado voters on Measure D have a say in how the current SANDAG mandate will be implemented. Raising construction height limits is an unacceptable solution.

Vote NO on Measure D. Hold the line that Coronado voters first drew in 1972 — protecting our community from undesirable density and structures that don't fit the unique character of Orange Avenue.

KEVIN SHAEFFER
Co-Chair, Coronado Republican Club (CRC)